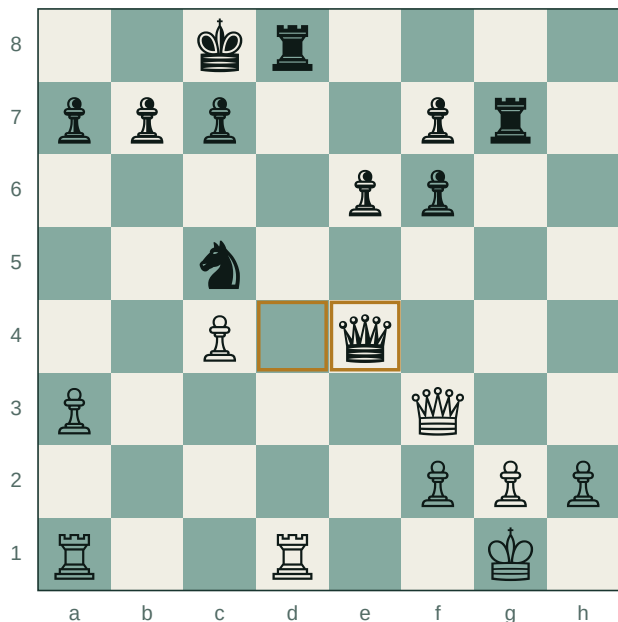


Attraction tactics: White, move 21

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 20...Qxe4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

21. Rxd8+ Kxd8 22. Qxf6+ Ke8 23. Qxg7

21.Rxd8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on d8. Recorded reply: **21...Kxd8**.

22.Qxf6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on d8 and rook on g7. Recorded reply: **22...Ke8**.

23.Qxg7 The queen captures the rook on g7.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -4 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on c8. Geometrically undefended: rook on g7 and knight on c5. Check for tactical protection.